

Clients — helix-core FFI, Flutter helix-ui, per-platform shims

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Master technical specification — document **03** of the HelixVPN set under docs/research/mvp/final/. Scope: the **client stack** — the Rust helix-core FFI surface consumed by the apps, the Flutter helix-ui codebase (design system + state + three flavors), and the **per-platform TunnelPlatform shims** (the only platform-specific code). This is a SPEC: it describes *what to build and why*, to phase → task → subtask and near-code granularity. It does **not** build the product (two-to-three refinement passes follow).

Boundary with sibling docs. This document **consumes** the data-plane contract owned by doc 01 (the Transport trait, helix-wg, the orchestrator, the TunnelStatus event stream) and the control-plane / proto contract owned by doc 02 (REST/WS, WatchNetworkMap, enrollment). It **owns** everything from the FFI surface upward: how Dart drives the core, how every pixel is shared across 3 apps × 8 platforms, and how each OS's tunnel lifecycle is isolated behind one channel contract. The Rust *internals* of helix-core are doc 01's; this doc owns only its *exported* surface.

Evidence base. Citations inline by id: [04_ARCH \$N] = 04_VPN_CLD/HelixVPN-Architecture-Refined.md; [04_UI] = 04_VPN_CLD/HelixVPN-helix-ui-Flutter.md; [04_P0] = ...Phase0-Spike.md; [04_P1] = ...Phase1-MVP.md; [04_P2] = ...Phase2-Parity.md; [05_YB0] = operator mandate; per-LLM analyses [02_QWN] [07_GMI] [10_KMI] [11_MST] etc.; [SYN] = cross-document synthesis.

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0. Position in the system & what this document owns

HelixVPN ships **three first-party app classes** — **Helix Access** (end user), **Helix Connector** (network operator), **Helix Console** (admin) — across **eight platforms** (iOS, Android, macOS, Windows, Linux, Web, HarmonyOS NEXT, Aurora OS), all from **one Flutter codebase** sitting on **one Rust core** [04_ARCH §5, 04_UI §0, 05_YBO]. The discipline of the whole client stack:

One widget tree, three flavors, eight targets — and the only per-platform code is the thin tunnel shim. [04_UI §0]

This document owns four contracts and nothing else:

#	Contract	Owned here	Consumed from
C1	FFI surface — the exact Dart-facing API of helix-core (start/stop/status_stream/exits/shields/advertise) and the mirrored TunnelStatus enum	§3	helix-core internals → doc 01
C2	TunnelPlatform shim contract — the single MethodChannel+EventChannel every OS implements	§4–5	OS tunnel APIs (NE, VpnService, ...)
C3	Flavor + capability model — runHelixApp(flavor, home, capabilities); what compiles into Access vs Connector vs Console	§6	—
C4	helix_design + Riverpod data layer — tokens, signature components, the "UI is a pure function of the status stream" rule	§7–8	helix_api (REST/WS) → doc 02

The load-bearing invariant that justifies the entire split [04_ARCH §5.1, 04_UI §10, SYN §5]:

A VPN client is two programs fused: a bounded-memory data-plane core (crypto, packet I/O, obfuscation — line-rate, must NOT be Dart, must NOT be reimplemented per platform) and a UI/orchestration layer (screens, settings, picker — benefits from one cross-platform toolkit). Hence Rust core + Flutter UI, never one framework doing everything.

0.1 Non-negotiable client invariants

#	Invariant	Source
CI1	helix_core_ffi owns <i>logic and status</i> ; it does NOT own the OS tunnel lifecycle — that is the platform shim, because on most platforms the tunnel runs in a separate OS-managed process/extension.	[04_UI §5]
CI2	The UI is a pure function of the core's status stream. No polling; the ConnectButton reflects a stream the Rust core pushes.	[04_UI §4.2]
CI3	Console builds to Web; Access/Connector do not need to — browsers cannot open a TUN. Console depends on <i>helix_api only</i> (no <i>helix_core_ffi</i>).	[04_ARCH §5.7, 04_UI §1]
CI4	iOS Network Extension memory ceiling (historically ~15 MB working set) is the hardest constraint and the single strongest reason the core is Rust not Go. Every platform/transport decision defers to it.	[04_ARCH §5.6/§5.7, 04_P0 §6]
CI5	State must be announced, not just colored — never rely on color alone for protected/unprotected (accessibility + safety).	[04_UI §9]
CI6	Never Electron, never webview-wrapped for native targets. Flutter AOT + Rust core is the <i>only</i> way the size/speed targets are reachable on 8 platforms at once.	[04_UI §10, 04_ARCH §5.6]

1. The shared-codebase strategy: two cores, thin shims

flowchart TB

```

    subgraph Shared["SHARED – written once"]
        direction TB
        UI["helix-ui (Flutter/Dart)<br>design system · screens · state · API client"]
        FFI["helix_core_ffi<br>(flutter_rust_bridge v2 bindings)"]
        CORE["helix-core (Rust)<br>WG control · helix-transport · reconciler · kill-switch · DNS"]
        UI --> FFI --> CORE
    end
    subgraph Shims["PER-PLATFORM – the irreducible minimum (a few hundred LOC each)"]
        direction LR
        S_APPLE["apple/<br>NEPacketTunnelProvider (Swift)"]
    end
```

```

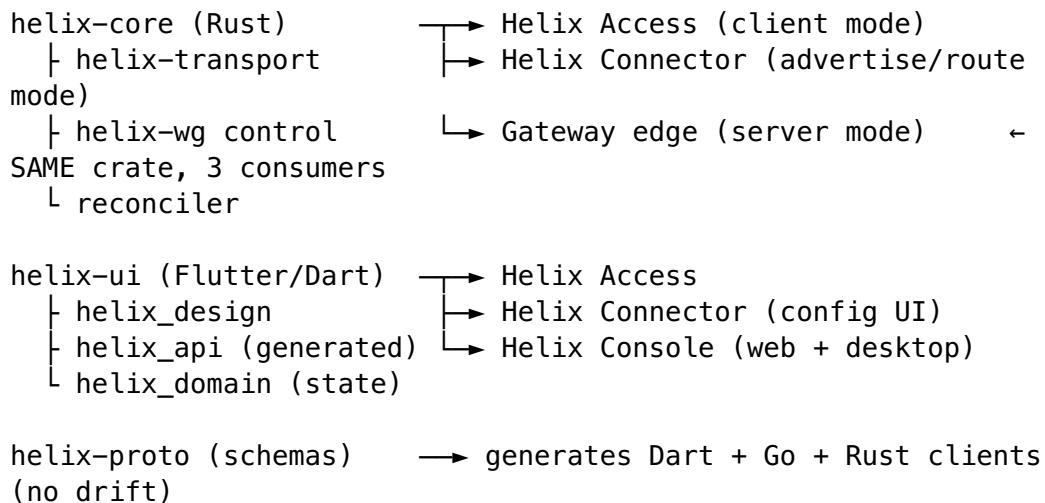
S_ANDROID["android/<br>VpnService + JNI (Kotlin)"]
S_WIN["windows/<br>wireguard-nt + service (Rust/C#)"]
S_LINUX["linux/<br>kernel WG / tun (Rust)"]
S_OHOS["harmonyos/<br>Network Kit ability (ArkTS-NAPI)"]
S_AURORA["aurora/<br>Qt/C++ + tun"]
S_WEB["web/<br>- none - (Console only)"]
end
CORE -. "UniFFI / cbindgen static-lib" .-> S_APPLE
CORE -. JNI .-> S_ANDROID
CORE -. named-pipe IPC .-> S_WIN
CORE -. in-process .-> S_LINUX
CORE -. "NAPI .so" .-> S_OHOS
CORE -. "C ABI" .-> S_AURORA
UI -. "TunnelPlatform channel" .-> S_APPLE & S_ANDROID & S_WIN
& S_LINUX & S_OHOS & S_AURORA

```

Three reuse pillars [04_ARCH §5.5, SYN §6]:

1. **Rust core** (helix-core) — data plane shared by **client + connector + gateway edge** (same crate, three consumers — doc 01 I4).
2. **Flutter UI** (helix-ui) — every screen shared by **all three apps**.
3. **Schema-generated clients** (helix-proto) — Dart/Go/Rust clients generated from one schema so the codebases never drift (doc 02).

The reuse map [04_ARCH §5.5]:



2. melos monorepo layout (helix-ui/)

The Flutter codebase is a melos-managed multi-package workspace [04_UI §1/§11]. Decoupling per §11.4.28/§11.4.74: helix_design, helix_api, and helix_core_ffi are independently publishable / reusable; project-specific glue lives only in helix_domain and the three apps/.

```

helix-ui/
├─ melos.yaml                # workspace task runner
(bootstrap/version/run-everywhere)
├─ packages/

```

```

|   |— helix_design/                # tokens · theme · widgets ·
icons · motion → reusable
|   |   |— lib/
|   |   |— tokens.dart              # HelixTokens (palette,
spacing, radius, type, motion)
|   |   |— theme.dart              # HelixTheme ThemeExtension
on ThemeData
|   |   |— widgets/                # ConnectButton, StatusChip,
ExitPicker, ShieldIndicator,
|   |   |— PolicyEditor, AdaptiveScaffold
|   |   |   |— motion.dart
|   |— helix_core_fffi/            # flutter_rust_bridge
bindings to helix-core (Access/Connector)
|   |   |— lib/
|   |   |— frb_generated.dart      # GENERATED – do not hand-
edit
|   |   |— helix_core.dart          # thin idiomatic wrapper
over the generated API
|   |   |   |— tunnel_platform.dart # TunnelPlatform channel
contract (§4)
|   |   |— rust/ → ../../helix-core/crates/helix-ffi # symlink
to the Rust FFI crate
|   |— helix_api/                  # generated OpenAPI REST
client + WS/SSE client (all apps)
|   |   |— lib/{rest_generated.dart, ws_client.dart}
|   |— helix_domain/               # models, Riverpod providers,
use-cases, runHelixApp()
|   |   |— lib/{run_helix_app.dart, providers/, usecases/,
models/}
|   |— helix_l10n/                 # ARB localization (en, ru,
zh-Hans, ...)
|— apps/
|   |— access/                     # flavor: end-user VPN app
(core_fffi + design + domain)
|   |   |— lib/main_access.dart
|   |   |— ios/ macos/             # NEPacketTunnelProvider shim
(Swift)
|   |   |— android/                # VpnService shim (Kotlin)
|   |   |— windows/ linux/         # service / in-process shims
|   |   |— ohos/                   # HarmonyOS HAP + ArkTS
ability (OpenHarmony SIG fork)
|   |   |— aurora/                 # Aurora RPM + Qt/C++ backend
(OMP fork)
|   |— connector/                  # flavor: network-side config
UI (core_fffi advertise mode)
|   |   |— lib/main_connector.dart # + headless daemon
entrypoint (no UI) reuses same core
|   |— console/                    # flavor: admin console –
helix_api ONLY, no core_fffi
|   |   |— lib/main_console.dart   # the ONLY flavor that builds
to Web
|   |— tool/                       # codegen scripts (frb,
openapi, intl), drift checks

```

Why console/ has no core_ffi dependency: capability gating (§6) + dependency separation. Console never tunnels, so it never links the Rust staticlib; this is what lets it build to Web (CI3) and keeps its bundle lean. Access + Connector additionally share **one Rust VPN/transport core**; all three share **one design system, one Dart UI core, one API client** [04_UI §1].

helix-ui/ is *one* package-group of the umbrella repo. The Rust crates (helix-core/, helix-edge/), the Go control plane (helix-go/), the schemas (helix-proto/), and the platform shim roots live as siblings under the umbrella per [04_ARCH §11] (see doc 00 §13 for the umbrella layout). Each reusable component graduates to its own vasic-digital repo with upstreams/

- install_upstreams per §11.4.28/§11.4.36.

3. The FFI surface — Dart $\rightleftharpoons$ helix-core

The Phase-0 G5 boundary, promoted to the production contract [04_P0 §9, 04_UI §5]. **flutter_rust_bridge v2 (frb)** generates the Dart $\rightleftharpoons$ Rust glue from the Rust helix-ffi crate; **UniFFI** generates the native-shim bindings (Swift / Kotlin / C) where a platform extension links the core directly rather than going through Dart [04_ARCH §5.1]. Two binding generators, one Rust surface — the canonical Mullvad/WARP pattern.

3.1 The Rust-side source of truth (helix-ffi/src/api.rs)

This is the *only* hand-authored FFI source; both generators read it. It is a SPEC sketch — final field sets are ratified at the Phase-0 $\rightarrow$ Phase-1 graduation [04_P0 §11].

```
// helix-ffi/src/api.rs - frb + UniFFI generate Dart/Swift/
//                               Kotlin/C bindings from this.
// The transport/WG internals are doc 01's; this is purely the
//                               EXPORTED surface.

pub struct ClientConfig {
    pub map_path_or_session: String, // file in Phase 0; control-
    //                               plane session token in Phase 1+
    pub transport: String,           // "auto" | "plain" |
    //                               "masque" | "shadowsocks" | "uot" | "lwo"
    pub mode: CoreMode,              // Client | Connector
}

#[frb(mirror)]
pub enum CoreMode { Client, Connector }

// ---- lifecycle (logic only - NOT the OS tunnel; the shim owns
//                               that, CI1) ----
pub async fn start(cfg: ClientConfig) -> anyhow::Result<>;
pub async fn stop() -> anyhow::Result<>;
```

```

// ---- the live status stream (maps to the orchestrator broadcast
//       channel, doc 01 §4.5) ----
pub fn status_stream(sink: StreamSink<TunnelStatus>);

// ---- exits / routing (Phase 1+) ----
pub async fn exits() -> anyhow::Result<Vec<ExitOption>>;
pub async fn set_exit(id: String, multi_hop_chain:
    Option<Vec<String>>) -> anyhow::Result<()>;

// ---- privacy shields ----
pub async fn set_shields(s: Shields) -> anyhow::Result<()>;

// ---- connector mode only ----
pub async fn advertise(cidrs: Vec<String>) ->
    anyhow::Result<AdvertiseResult>;

// ---- shim handoff: the core never opens the TUN; the shim hands
//       it a packet fd / pump ----
pub fn attach_tun(fd: i32) ->
    anyhow::Result<()>; // Android ParcelFileDescriptor,
    // Linux tun fd
pub fn detach_tun() -> anyhow::Result<()>;

#[frb(mirror)]
pub enum TunnelStatus {
    Disconnected,
    Connecting,
    Handshaking,
    Connected { transport: String, path: String, rtt_ms:
        u32 }, // path = "direct" | "relay"
    Reconnecting,
    Down { reason:
        String }, // distinct from Disconnected: an
        // unexpected drop
    Danger { kind: String }, // "leak" |
        // "killswitch_tripped" - drives the red palette (§7)
}

#[frb(mirror)]
pub struct Shields {
    pub kill_switch: bool,
    pub dns_protection: bool,
    pub daita: bool,
    pub post_quantum: bool,
    pub split_tunnel: Vec<String>, // per-route bypass; per-app
        // handled in the shim layer
}

#[frb(mirror)]
pub struct ExitOption {
    pub id: String, pub kind: String, // "privacy_exit" |
        // "network"
    pub label: String, pub country: Option<String>, pub rtt_ms:
        Option<u32>,

```

```

    pub jurisdiction: Option<String>, // for multi-hop labels
}

#[frb(mirror)]
pub struct AdvertiseResult { pub accepted: Vec<String>, pub
    conflicts: Vec<String> }

```

Status-enum note. The Phase-0 spike shipped the lean five-variant enum Connecting | Handshaking | Connected{transport,rtt} | Reconnecting | Down{reason} [04_P0 §4.5/§9]. This document **mirrors and extends** it to add Disconnected (clean idle, distinct from Down), path on Connected (direct vs relay — surfaced by the StatusChip), and Danger{kind} (leak / kill-switch tripped — drives the red stateDanger palette). The Dart mirror in §3.2 MUST match byte-for-byte; the FFI contract test (§12) asserts it.

3.2 The Dart-facing surface (helix_core.dart)

frb mirrors every #[frb(mirror)] type into an identical Dart type, so the Dart TunnelStatus is the *generated* mirror, never a hand-written parallel. The thin wrapper adds ergonomics only:

```

// helix_core_ffl/lib/helix_core.dart – idiomatic wrapper over
// frb_generated.dart
abstract class HelixCore {
    Future<void> start({required String transport, String?
        mapPathOrSession,
        CoreMode mode = CoreMode.client});
    Future<void> stop();

    Stream<TunnelStatus> statusStream(); // frb StreamSink
        → Dart broadcast Stream

    Future<List<ExitOption>> exits();
    Future<void> setExit(String id, {List<String>? multiHopChain});
    Future<void> setShields(Shields s);

    // connector mode:
    Future<AdvertiseResult> advertise(List<String> cidrs);

    // shim handoff (called by the platform shim, not the UI):
    Future<void> attachTun(int fd);
    Future<void> detachTun();
}

// the entire happy path a client app drives (mirrors the Phase-0
// G5 demo, [04_P0 §9]):
await core.start(transport: 'auto', mapPathOrSession:
    session.token);
core.statusStream().listen((s) => /* Riverpod fold, §8 */);
// ...later:
await core.stop();

```


3.3 FFI ⇔ shim division of labor (the seam that prevents the classic bug)

```
sequenceDiagram
    participant UI as Flutter UI (Dart)
    participant FFI as helix_core_ffi (frb)
    participant SHIM as TunnelPlatform shim (native)
    participant OS as OS tunnel (NE / VpnService / wg-nt / tun)
    participant CORE as helix-core (Rust)

    UI->>SHIM: startTunnel(TunnelConfig)          %% via
MethodChannel
    SHIM->>OS: request permission + create TUN (overlay IP,
routes, DNS)
    OS-->>SHIM: tun fd / packetFlow
    SHIM->>CORE: helix_core_start(cfg) + attach_tun(fd)    %% via
UniFFI/JNI/C ABI
    SHIM-->>UI: PlatformTunnelEvent.up                %% via
EventChannel
    Note over CORE: pumps tun ↔ WG ↔ transport (doc 01)
    CORE-->>FFI: TunnelStatus events (StreamSink)
    FFI-->>UI: statusStream() → ConnectButton/StatusChip
    UI->>FFI: core.setShields(...) / setExit(...)    %% logic-
only, no OS tunnel
    UI->>SHIM: stopTunnel()
    SHIM->>CORE: detach_tun() + helix_core_stop()
    OS-->>SHIM: tunnel torn down
    SHIM-->>UI: PlatformTunnelEvent.down
```

The seam: **lifecycle commands flow UI → shim → core** (the OS owns the tunnel process), while **status events flow core → FFI → UI** (the core owns truth about protection state). `setShields/setExit/exits` are pure logic and go straight UI → FFI without touching the OS tunnel (CI1). This is precisely the boundary that prevents "UI says connected while the OS tunnel is actually down": the UI *only* believes the core's `statusStream`, never its own intent (CI2; §8.4).

4. The TunnelPlatform shim contract (the only platform-specific code)

Every shim implements **one contract** and does **only three things**: configure the OS tunnel, hand packets to/from `helix-core`, and report lifecycle [04_UI §6]. Everything else is shared Dart.

```
// helix_core_ffi/lib/tunnel_platform.dart
// One MethodChannel ("helixvpn/tunnel") + one EventChannel
// ("helixvpn/tunnel/events").
abstract class TunnelPlatform {
    /// OS asks permission, creates the TUN, links the core, starts
    /// the pump.
    Future<void> startTunnel(TunnelConfig cfg);
```

```

    /// Tear down: detach core, destroy TUN, release permission
    hold.
    Future<void> stopTunnel();

    /// Lifecycle only – NOT data. Up/down/permissionDenied/revoked/
    error.
    Stream<PlatformTunnelEvent> events();
}

class TunnelConfig {
    final String overlayIp;           // e.g. 100.64.0.7/32 (or
    fd7a:::/128 for v6 overlay)
    final List<String> routes;        // AllowedIPs the OS should
    send into the tunnel
    final List<String>
        dnsServers;    // tunnel DNS (kill plaintext :53 off-
    tunnel)
    final List<String> splitExcludeApps; // Android/desktop per-app
    bypass (platform-handled)
    final int mtu;           // negotiated; default 1280
    over MASQUE, 1420 plain WG
    final String sessionOrMapToken;    // handed straight to
    helix_core_start
    TunnelConfig({required this.overlayIp, required this.routes,
        required this.dnsServers,
        this.splitExcludeApps = const [], this.mtu = 1280, required
        this.sessionOrMapToken});
}

enum PlatformTunnelEventKind { up, down, permissionDenied,
    revoked, error }
class PlatformTunnelEvent {
    final PlatformTunnelEventKind kind;
    final String? detail;           // honest reason on error/
    revoked (§11.4.6: no guessing)
    PlatformTunnelEvent(this.kind, [this.detail]);
}

```

4.1 Contract obligations (every shim MUST satisfy)

#	Obligation	Why
O1	startTunnel is idempotent + permission-aware : if the OS denies VPN permission, emit permissionDenied (not error) and leave no half-open TUN (§11.4.14 cleanup).	clean UX, no leaks
O2	The shim hands the core a packet fd / pump , it does not itself crypto/obfuscate. helix-core is the only place WG + transport live (doc 01 I4).	one core, no fork
O3	events() reports revoked when the OS (or admin via device.revoked, doc 02) kills the tunnel out-of-band — the UI must show this within the §11.4.x convergence budget, never claim "connected".	CI2 honesty
O4		§11.4.14

#	Obligation	Why
	On <code>stopTunnel</code> the shim restores the OS to a quiescent state (no orphan routes, no leaked DNS, kill-switch firewall rules removed) on every exit path (finally/defer).	
O5	The shim is the only untyped seam (native $\rightleftharpoons$ Dart) — it is covered by a per-OS smoke test on real devices (§12), never by mocks-claiming-PASS.	§11.4.27

5. Per-platform shim implementations

The matrix (one row = one `TunnelPlatform` impl) [04_ARCH §5.3, 04_UI §6]:

Platform	OS mechanism	Shim language	How helix-core is loaded	Core[?]OS packet path
iOS / macOS	<code>NEPacketTunnelProvider</code> (Network Extension)	Swift	Rust staticlib (aarch64-apple-ios) linked into the extension; UniFFI/cbindgen header	<code>packetFlow.readPacket</code> $\rightleftharpoons$ <code>core.attach_tun</code>
Android	<code>VpnService</code> + foreground service	Kotlin	<code>core .so</code> via JNI	<code>ParcelFileDescriptor</code> $\rightarrow$ <code>attach_tun(fd)</code>
Windows	<code>wireguard-nt</code> / <code>wintun</code> + privileged service	C# (+Rust)	service process hosts the core; Flutter [?] service over named-pipe IPC	<code>wintun ring</code> $\rightleftharpoons$ core
Linux	kernel <code>wireguard</code> or <code>tun</code>	Rust / Dart FFI	core in-process (desktop) or a small helper daemon	<code>tun fd</code> $\rightarrow$ <code>attach_tun(fd)</code>
HarmonyOS NEXT	Network Kit VPN extension <i>ability</i>	ArkTS shim $\rightarrow$ NAPI	core as native <code>.so</code> via N-API ; ArkTS <code>MethodChannel</code> bridges to Flutter	<code>ability tun</code> $\rightleftharpoons$ core
Aurora OS	Qt/C++ network backend + <code>tun</code>	C++ shim	core linked as C lib into the Qt backend; Friflex Flutter plugin bridges	Qt backend <code>tun</code> $\rightleftharpoons$ core
Web (Console only)	— none —	n/a	no tunnel — Console is API-only (CI3)	—

The payoff [04_UI §6]: ConnectButton, ExitPicker, settings, account, policy views — *every pixel* — are identical Dart across all of these. Adding HarmonyOS or Aurora is "write one shim that satisfies TunnelPlatform + bend the build," not "port the app." The UI ports for free; the *shim* does not.

5.1 iOS / macOS — NEPacketTunnelProvider (Swift)

The make-or-break platform (CI4). The core is a Rust **staticlib** linked into a Network Extension; the extension owns packetFlow and pumps it through the core [04_P0 §6].

```
// apps/access/ios/HelixTunnel/PacketTunnelProvider.swift
import NetworkExtension

final class PacketTunnelProvider: NEPacketTunnelProvider {
    override func startTunnel(options: [String:NSObject]?,
                               completionHandler: @escaping (Error?)
                                   -> Void) {
        let cfg = decodeTunnelConfig(options) // overlay
            IP, routes, DNS, session token
        let settings =
            NEPacketTunnelNetworkSettings(tunnelRemoteAddress:
            cfg.gatewayHost)
        settings.ipv4Settings = NEIPv4Settings(addresses:
            [cfg.overlayIp], subnetMasks: ["255.255.255.255"])
        settings.dnsSettings = NEDNSSettings(servers:
            cfg.dnsServers) // tunnel DNS (anti-leak)
        settings.ipv4Settings?.includedRoutes = cfg.routes.map {
            NEIPv4Route(...) } // AllowedIPs
        setTunnelNetworkSettings(settings) { [weak self] err in
            guard err == nil, let self else { return
            completionHandler(err) }
            helix_core_start(cfg.sessionToken,
            CoreMode.client) // UniFFI/cbindgen

            self.pump() //
            packetFlow ⇌ core
            completionHandler(nil)
        }
    }

    private func pump() {
        packetFlow.readPackets { [weak self] packets, _ in
            for p in packets { helix_core_tun_out(p) } // core
            encrypts + sends via transport
            self?.pump()
        }
        helix_core_set_tun_writer { data in
            self.packetFlow.writePackets([data], withProtocols:
            [AF_INET]) }
    }

    override func stopTunnel(with reason: NEProviderStopReason,
```

```

                                completionHandler: @escaping () ->
Void) {
    helix_core_stop(); completionHandler()           // 04:
    quiescent restore
}
}

```

The memory constraint is the architecture. The Phase-0 G3 gate [04_P0 §6.3/ §6.4] mandates: build the same helix-core as aarch64-apple-ios with opt-level=z/s + LTO + panic=abort + strip; drive a sustained **1 GB transfer on a real device** (Simulator memory is *not* representative); sample the **extension process** RSS via Instruments; run **plain-UDP and MASQUE separately** (QUIC buffers cost more memory — both must pass). **Pass = steady-state RSS under the device-enforced ceiling with $\geq 30\%$ headroom across a 30-minute soak.** If it fails, the documented fallbacks in order are: (1) shrink buffers / cap QUIC flow-control windows in the iOS build; (2) move MASQUE off-device for iOS (plain WG + on-path obfuscation only — partial feature loss); (3) split the core so only the lean WG datapath is in-extension and QUIC negotiation lives in the app via app-extension IPC. Each fallback is a real product decision (§14 D-CLIENT-1) — never hand-waved [04_P0 §6.4].

5.2 Android — VpnService + JNI (Kotlin)

```

// apps/access/android/.../HelixVpnService.kt
class HelixVpnService : VpnService() {
    private external fun coreStart(sessionToken: String, fd:
        Int) // JNI → helix-core .so
    private external fun coreStop()
    init { System.loadLibrary("helix_core") }

    override fun onStartCommand(intent: Intent?, flags: Int,
        startId: Int): Int {
        val cfg = TunnelConfig.from(intent)
        val builder = Builder()
            .addAddress(cfg.overlayIp, 32)
            .setMtu(cfg.mtu)
        cfg.routes.forEach { builder.addRoute(it.addr,
            it.prefix) } // AllowedIPs
        cfg.dnsServers.forEach {
            builder.addDnsServer(it) } // tunnel DNS
        cfg.splitExcludeApps.forEach {
            builder.addDisallowedApplication(it) } // per-app split
        val pfd: ParcelFileDescriptor =
            builder.establish()!! // OS creates TUN
        startForeground(NOTIF_ID,
            persistentNotification()) // required: bg
            tunnel
        coreStart(cfg.sessionToken,
            pfd.fd) // hand fd to core
            (attach_tun)
        return START_STICKY
    }
    override fun onRevoke() { coreStop();
        emitEvent(REVOKED) } // 03: OS killed us
}

```

```

    override fun onDestroy() { coreStop();
        stopForeground(true) } // 04
}

```

5.3 Windows — wireguard-nt/wintun + privileged service (C#/Rust)

Flutter runs unprivileged; the tunnel needs admin. So a **privileged Windows service** hosts the core and the wireguard-nt adapter; the Flutter app talks to it over a **named pipe** [04_ARCH §5.3, 04_UI §6].

```

[Flutter app (user)] --named-pipe (\\.\pipe\helixvpn)-->
[HelixTunnelSvc (SYSTEM)]

```

wireguard-nt / wintun adapter

helix-core (Rust, in-service)

- The service exposes the same TunnelPlatform verbs over the pipe (startTunnel/stopTunnel/event stream); the Flutter side is a TunnelPlatform impl that marshals to the pipe.
- Signing: the service binary + any kernel-adjacent driver are Authenticode-signed (§11; §11.4.133 target-system safety — no unsigned privileged code).
- Kill-switch on Windows is WFP (Windows Filtering Platform) rules driven by the core's state machine, removed on stopTunnel (O4).

5.4 Linux — kernel WG / tun (Rust, in-process)

Simplest case: on desktop Linux the core drives the TUN **in-process** (no separate service needed for a user-launched app; a setcap cap_net_admin helper or a small polkit-gated helper daemon covers the privilege) [04_ARCH §5.3, 04_P0 §9]. Kernel WireGuard is the fast path; boringtun userspace is the fallback (doc 01). This is the Phase-0 G5 reference platform — "on Linux the core can drive the TUN directly" [04_P0 §9].

5.5 HarmonyOS NEXT — Network Kit ability (ArkTS → NAPI) — Phase 3

HarmonyOS NEXT dropped Android/ART compatibility entirely (native ArkTS/ArkUI/DevEco only) [04_ARCH §5.2]. Build with the **OpenHarmony SIG Flutter fork** (gitee.com/openharmony-sig/flutter_flutter, ohos channel → HAP). The VPN *ability* and platform plugins are written in **ArkTS** and bridge via MethodChannel/NAPI to the Rust .so; sign in DevEco. The fork lags mainline Flutter — **pin versions, budget plugin work**: the UI ports for free, the shim does not [04_UI §6.1]. Biggest platform risk in the program (§13 Phase 3).

5.6 Aurora OS — Qt/C++ + tun (Phase 3)

Build with the **OMP Russia Flutter fork** (gitlab.com/omprussia/flutter, flutter-aurora → signed RPM); tunnel backend in **Qt/C++**, Flutter plugins via **Friflex** [04_ARCH §5.2, 04_UI §6.1]. Toolchain is Russian-hosted (GitLab

omprussia / Mos.Hub) and Aurora is enterprise/government-oriented — treat it as an **enterprise SKU** with its own CI runners and signing, not a consumer afterthought [04_ARCH §5.7].

5.7 Web — no shim (Console only)

Browsers cannot open a TUN device [04_ARCH §5.7, CI3]. The web build is **Helix Console (management) + account/config**, *plus an optional in-page WASM MASQUE client* that can proxy *the browser's own* traffic to a joined network — **not** a system-wide tunnel. State this plainly to users: "fully responsive web app" = the Console and a browser-scoped proxy, never a device VPN. The web flavor has **no TunnelPlatform implementation and no helix_core_ffi dependency**.

6. Three flavors from one tree (capability gating)

Flutter `--flavor` + distinct entrypoints select the app; shared code is 80–90 % of each [04_UI §2]. The flavor's **capability set** gates which features compile/appear — a capability the flavor lacks is **tree-shaken out**, keeping each binary lean.

```
// apps/access/lib/main_access.dart
void main() => runHelixApp(
  flavor: HelixFlavor.access,
  home: const ConnectScreen(),           // the big connect button
  capabilities: const {Capability.tunnel, Capability.account,
    Capability.splitTunnel},
);

// apps/connector/lib/main_connector.dart
void main() => runHelixApp(
  flavor: HelixFlavor.connector,
  home: const ConnectorDashboard(),      // advertise CIDs, local
    status
  capabilities: const {Capability.tunnel, Capability.advertise,
    Capability.localAcl},
);

// apps/console/lib/main_console.dart
void main() => runHelixApp(
  flavor: HelixFlavor.console,
  home: const ConsoleShell(),           // tenants/devices/networks/
    policy/audit
  capabilities: const {Capability.admin}, // NO
    Capability.tunnel → no core_ffi linked
);

// helix_domain/lib/run_helix_app.dart (the wiring point)
Future<void> runHelixApp({
  required HelixFlavor flavor,
  required Widget home,
  required Set<Capability> capabilities,
}) async {
```

```

final container = ProviderContainer(overrides: [
  flavorProvider.overrideWithValue(flavor),
  capabilitiesProvider.overrideWithValue(capabilities),
  // only flavors with Capability.tunnel get a real HelixCore;
  // Console gets a null impl:
  helixCoreProvider.overrideWith((ref) =>
    capabilities.contains(Capability.tunnel) ?
      RealHelixCore() : NoCore()),
]);
runApp(UncontrolledProviderScope(container: container,
  child: HelixApp(home: home, theme:
    helixTheme(flavor)))); // theme per role (§7)
}

```

Capability	Compiles in	In flavor
tunnel	helix_core_ffi, TunnelPlatform shim, ConnectButton, ShieldIndicator	Access, Connector
account	account screen, OIDC + anonymous device-token enrollment	Access
splitTunnel	per-app/per-route bypass UI	Access
advertise	CIDR advertise UI, overlapping-CIDR conflict surface	Connector
localAcl	site-local restriction editor	Connector
admin	tenants/devices/networks/policy/audit/topology + helix_api heavy tables	Console

Console = the only **Web build** because it lacks `Capability.tunnel`, so it never links the Rust staticlib (CI3). Connector additionally ships a **headless daemon endpoint** (the same Rust core, no Flutter UI) — the Flutter Connector UI is the *optional* config surface [04_ARCH §5.4].

7. helix_design — the design system

A VPN client's UI has one emotional center of gravity: **am I protected right now?** The system makes that state instantly legible, then gets out of the way [04_UI §3]. Material 3 is the substrate; brand tokens override the defaults so it never reads as a stock Flutter app (a real risk to design against).

7.1 Tokens — the single source of truth

```

// helix_design/lib/tokens.dart
class HelixTokens {
  // ---- connection-state palette (the signature semantic colors,
  // mapped to TunnelStatus) ----
  static const stateDisconnected = Color(0xFF6B7280); // neutral
  grey ← Disconnected
  static const stateConnecting = Color(0xFFFF59E0B); // amber,
  in-motion ← Connecting/Handshaking/Reconnecting

```



```

static const stateConnected    = Color(0xFF10B981); // green,
    safe    ← Connected
static const stateDanger      = Color(0xFFEF4444); //
    red          ← Danger{leak|killswitch_tripped}/Down

static const brandSeed =
    Color(0xFF3B5BDB);          // drives M3 ColorScheme,
    overridden per role

// spacing 4-base: 4 8 12 16 24 32 48 · radius sm8 md12 lg20
    pill999
// type: display/headline/title/body/label (M3 scale, brand font
    – NOT Roboto default)
// motion: fast120 base220 slow360, emphasized easing reserved
    for state change
// elevation 0..3 used sparingly; flat surfaces, color-as-
    hierarchy
}

```

light + dark are both first-class (privacy users skew dark; respect system + manual override) [04_UI §3.1/§9]. Tokens are consumed via a HelixTheme ThemeExtension so screens never hardcode colors/spacing — they reference roles (context.helix.stateConnected), which keeps the eight platforms visually identical and re-themeable (a future white-label is a **token swap, not a refactor**).

```

// helix_design/lib/theme.dart – the state→color mapping the whole
    app reads
extension HelixThemeX on BuildContext {
  Color colorForStatus(TunnelStatus s) => switch (s) {
    Disconnected() => HelixTokens.stateDisconnected,
    Connecting()   || Handshaking() || Reconnecting() =>
        HelixTokens.stateConnecting,
    Connected()    => HelixTokens.stateConnected,
    Danger() || Down() => HelixTokens.stateDanger,
  };
}

```

7.2 Signature components

Component	Purpose	Driven by
ConnectButton	the giant tap target; morphs disconnected→connecting→connected	statusStream color+label+motion (§8)
StatusChip	current transport · path · RTT (MASQUE · direct · 23ms)	live Connected{transport,path,rtt}
ExitPicker	choose exit gateway / network / multi-hop chain	core.exits(), RTT-sorted, jurisdiction labels
ShieldIndicator	kill-switch / DNS / DAITA / PQ badges	Shields + honest cost note on tap
NetworkTile	a joined network (Console/Access)	connector health, advertised CIDRs, access level
PolicyEditor	Console ACL editing	text + effect-diff preview (doc 02)

Component	Purpose	Driven by
AdaptiveScaffold	responsive shell: BottomNav (phone) ⇔ NavigationRail (tablet/desktop) ⇔ extended rail (web)	layout width, never Platform.isX

Avoiding the "default Flutter" look [04_UI §3.3]: a real brand typeface, restrained flat surfaces with color-as-hierarchy, one confident accent, generous spacing, and **motion reserved for state change** (the connect transition is the one place to spend animation budget). The connection state owns the screen; settings recede.

Accessibility (CI5): semantic labels on ConnectButton/ShieldIndicator announce state, large-text + high-contrast support, full keyboard nav on desktop/web — never rely on color alone for protected/unprotected [04_UI §9].

7.3 Responsive / adaptive (one tree, every form factor)

```
// breakpoints – branch on SIZE, never on Platform.isX (so a
//              resized desktop window
// behaves like a phone and web "just works")
compact (< 600) → BottomNavigationBar · single pane ·
              full-width ConnectButton
medium   (600–1024) → NavigationRail · master/detail
expanded (> 1024) → extended NavigationRail · multi-pane
              (Console: list | detail | live events)
```

Touch targets ≥ 48 dp on mobile; pointer + keyboard shortcuts (⌘K command palette in Console) on desktop/web. Console's heavy tables / topology graph / policy editor are **deferred-loaded** so they never bloat Access/Connector [04_UI §7].

8. Riverpod data layer

Riverpod is the choice [04_UI §4]: compile-safe DI, first-class turning of the FFI/WS **streams** into reactive UI, trivial to test (override providers), no BuildContext coupling. (Bloc is the viable alternative if the team prefers explicit event/state classes — the layering maps onto either; §14 D-CLIENT-2.)

8.1 Layering

UI (widgets) --watch-- Providers (state) --call-- Use-cases
 --use-- Repositories

└─ helix_core_ffl (tunnel control + status stream)

└─ helix_api (REST: enroll, devices, policy, networks → doc 02)

└─ WS/SSE client (live events for Console → doc 02)

8.2 The tunnel-state provider (Access / Connector)

```
// helix_domain – turn the Rust core's event stream into reactive
// Dart state
final tunnelStatusProvider = StreamProvider<TunnelStatus>((ref) {
  final core = ref.watch(helixCoreProvider);
  return core.statusStream(); // frb StreamSink → Dart
    Stream – NO polling (CI2)
});

final connectControllerProvider =
  AsyncNotifierProvider<ConnectController,
    void>(ConnectController.new);

class ConnectController extends AsyncNotifier<void> {
  @override Future<void> build() async {}
  Future<void> connect({String transport = 'auto'}) async {
    final cfg = await ref.read(sessionProvider).resolve();
    await ref.read(tunnelPlatformProvider).startTunnel(cfg); //
      shim creates TUN + links core
  }
  Future<void> disconnect() =>
    ref.read(tunnelPlatformProvider).stopTunnel();
  Future<void> toggle(TunnelStatus? s) =>
    (s is Connected) ? disconnect() : connect();
}

// the ConnectButton is a pure function of the stream – no
// polling, no manual refresh (CI2)
final status = ref.watch(tunnelStatusProvider);
ConnectButton(
  state: status.valueOrNull ?? const TunnelStatus.disconnected(),
  onTap: () =>
    ref.read(connectControllerProvider.notifier).toggle(status.valueOrNull),
);
```

8.3 Console live data

The Console subscribes to the control-plane WS/SSE (GET /v1/stream, doc 02) and folds events (device.online, route.changed, policy.compiled, device.revoked) into Riverpod state, so device lists, the topology view, and the audit feed update **live without refresh** [04_UI §4.3]. This is the Phase-1 event taxonomy made visible.

8.4 Offline / optimistic behavior (the honesty rule)

Access/Connector keep last-known status + a local *intent* (user wants connected) so a flaky control channel never makes the UI lie. **The core's status stream is always the source of truth for *actual* protection state**; the UI distinguishes intended from actual (e.g. Reconnecting...) and never paints green on intent alone [04_UI §4.4, CI2]. A Danger status overrides any intent and paints the red palette immediately.

9. Why Flutter for 8 platforms (and not the alternatives)

The brief mandates **iOS, Android, Aurora, HarmonyOS, Windows, Linux, macOS, Web** [05_YBO]. Only Flutter reaches all of them [04_ARCH §5.2]:

Target	Flutter path	KMP / Compose MP
iOS / Android	mainline	✓
Windows / Linux / macOS	mainline	✓ (Desktop JVM)
Web	mainline (CanvasKit / Wasm)	✓ (Wasm/JS)
Aurora OS	OMP fork flutter-aurora → signed RPM (plugins via Friflex)	✗ none
HarmonyOS NEXT	OpenHarmony SIG fork ohos channel → HAP (ArkTS plugins)	✗ none

HarmonyOS NEXT dropped Android/ART entirely (native ArkTS/ArkUI/DevEco only) and Aurora is Qt/QML-native — so an Android APK or a KMP artifact simply will not run on either. The Flutter forks are the **only** realistic single-codebase path [04_ARCH §5.2]. **Conclusion: Flutter for UI; KMP is not viable for the full target set.** Combined with the Rust core, this is the only way to hit *tiny + fast + 8-platform* simultaneously (CI6).

10. Size / memory / performance budgets

The brief demands tiny, fast, stable [04_UI §10, 05_YBO]. Concrete targets and the means:

Budget	Target	How
Mobile install size	Access < ~15–20 MB per ABI	--split-per-abi, tree-shake icons/fonts, no bundled video, lean Rust staticlib (LTO + strip)
Cold start	< 1 s mid-range mobile	AOT, deferred non-critical providers, no work on the UI thread at launch
Idle app memory	single-digit → low-tens MB	Flutter AOT (no Electron); tunnel-core memory is the Rust budget
iOS NE tunnel core RSS	under device ceiling, ≥ 30 % headroom (G3)	Rust core opt-level=z/s+LTO+panic=abort+strip; real-device 1 GB soak; both transports (CI4, §5.1)
Frame budget	60/120 fps, no jank	const widgets, RepaintBoundary on animated state, motion only on state change
Web (Console)	fast first paint	Wasm/CanvasKit, route-level deferred loading, no core_ffi weight

Non-negotiable (CI6): never Electron, never a webview-wrapped app for native targets. **Flutter AOT + Rust core is the entire reason the size/speed targets are reachable on eight platforms at once** [04_UI §10]. The iOS NE ceiling is the *reason the core is Rust not Go* — a Go data plane with its runtime + GC would risk the ~15 MB working set [04_ARCH §5.6, SYN §5].

11. Build, codegen, signing, CI

§11.4.156 — **NO active server-side CI.** GitHub Actions / GitLab pipelines are disabled across all owned repos [SYN §9]. The "CI matrix" below describes the *local* melos build/test ritual + the operator's pre-tag sweep (§11.4.40), not a hosted runner. Any preserved workflow file is named *.disabled-local-only.

- **melos** runs analyze/test/build across packages; each app builds per platform via its flavor [04_UI §11].
 - **Build matrix:** mainline Flutter for iOS/Android/Win/macOS/Linux/Web; **separate (local) runners** for the OpenHarmony SIG fork (HAP, DevEco signing) and the OMP fork (Aurora RPM signing) — pinned to specific fork versions and **isolated so a fork lag never blocks mainline releases**.
 - **Codegen + drift check (the no-drift guarantee):** flutter_rust_bridge bindings, OpenAPI→Dart client, and intl ARBs are generated and **checked for drift** — the apps can never silently diverge from the Rust core or the control-plane API [04_UI §11, 04_ARCH §4.2]. A drift is a build-blocking finding (§12 FFI contract test).
 - **Signing/notarization per platform:** Apple notarize; Windows Authenticode-sign the service + any driver; HarmonyOS DevEco; Aurora RPM sign (§11.4.133 — no unsigned privileged code) [04_UI §11].
 - **Recording / release prefixes:** every QA recording is prefixed helixvpn---<feature>---<run-id>.mp4 (§11.4.155); release tags helixvpn-<version> (§11.4.151) [SYN §9].
-

12. Testing strategy + anti-bluff evidence

Every PASS carries captured evidence per §11.4.5/§11.4.69/§11.4.107; the shim is the only untyped seam and is covered on real devices (O5). [04_UI §12]

Layer	Tooling	What it proves	Evidence
Widget	flutter_test	each component renders per state (ConnectButton across every TunnelStatus)	golden frames
Golden	golden_toolkit	the design system stays visually stable across themes/breakpoints (light+dark, compact/medium/expanded)	golden PNGs
State	Riverpod overrides		test logs

Layer	Tooling	What it proves	Evidence
Integration	integration_test	controllers/use-cases with a fake HelixCore + fake API (same generated model types) flavor flows: connect→status, advertise→accepted, policy-edit→effect-diff	run recording
FFI contract	shared fixtures	the Dart TunnelStatus/ExitOption/Shields mirrors match the Rust helix-ffi types byte-for-byte (generated, asserted) — a drift FAILs the build	golden fixture diff
Platform shim	per-OS smoke on real devices	tunnel up/down/permission/revoke + the iOS NE memory soak (G3) — never a mock-claiming-PASS (§11.4.27)	device RSS report + window-scoped MP4 (§11.4.159)

Anti-bluff coupling (§11.4.107/§11.4.158). A green widget test is not proof the user is protected. The **integration + platform-shim layers** are the evidence: a window-scoped MP4 of the real connect journey on a real device, with the StatusChip reading MASQUE · direct · 23ms confirmed by OCR/vision validation, plus the iOS NE Instruments RSS report. Fake the core/API with the *same model types the generators produce* so unit tests exercise real contracts; but the user-visible claim is only earned by the device recording.

13. Phase → task → subtask plan

Aligned to the program roadmap [SYN §4, 04_P0/P1/P2/P3]. Each subtask is a workable item (§11.4.93 SQLite SSoT).

Phase 0 — prove the client seams (the spike) [04_P0]

- **T0.1 FFI boundary (gate G5).**
 - S0.1.1 Author helix-ffi/src/api.rs minimal surface (start/stop/status_stream).
 - S0.1.2 frb v2 codegen → frb_generated.dart; thin HelixCore wrapper.
 - S0.1.3 Flutter-Linux window: one connect/disconnect toggle + a StatusChip that goes Connecting → Handshaking → Connected(masque, 23ms) driven *only* by the Rust event stream. **G5 pass = that demo recorded** [04_P0 §9].
- **T0.2 iOS NE memory experiment (gate G3 — make-or-break).**
 - S0.2.1 Build helix-core as aarch64-apple-ios staticlib (z/s+LTO+strip); record binary size.
 - S0.2.2 PacketTunnelProvider skeleton; pump packetFlow ≠ core.

- S0.2.3 Real-device 1 GB soak, plain-UDP *and* MASQUE separately; Instruments RSS on the **extension** process. **G3 pass** = $\geq 30\%$ **headroom**, **30-min soak, both transports** [04_P0 §6]. Record the verdict + fallbacks (§5.1).
- **T0.3 Static-map reconcile in the UI (gate G6)**. Drive `core.start(mapPath)` against `/etc/helix/map.json` (the exact shape Phase-1 `WatchNetworkMap` will stream); prove the `ConnectButton` reflects reconcile outcomes.

Phase 1 — MVP client (self-hostable) [04_P1]

- **T1.1 Promote the FFI surface** to the Phase-1 field set (`exits`, `setExit`, `setShields`, `advertise`, `attach_tun`); regenerate + drift-gate.
- **T1.2 helix_design v1** — tokens, `HelixTheme`, the 7 signature components, light+dark, golden tests.
- **T1.3 Riverpod data layer** — `tunnelStatusProvider`, `ConnectController`, `helix_api` (generated REST) + WS client; offline/intent honesty (§8.4).
- **T1.4 Three flavors** — `runHelixApp` + capability gating; Access (`Connect/Exits/Shields/Account`), `Connector` (`Dashboard/Advertise/Local-ACL/headless`), `Console` (`Devices/Networks/Policy/Audit/Topology`, Web build).
- **T1.5 Production shims (desktop+mobile)** — Linux in-process, Android `VpnService+JNI`, iOS/macOS NE, Windows `service+pipe`. Per-OS real-device smoke.
- **T1.6 Enrollment UX** — device-generated WG keypair (private key never leaves), OIDC + anonymous device-token paths, QR enroll-token minting in Console.
- **T1.7 Kill-switch + DNS-leak UI** — `ShieldIndicator` wired to core state; Danger palette on trip; honest cost notes.

Phase 2 — parity + reach (client surface) [04_P2]

- **T2.1 ExitPicker multi-hop** — chain builder, jurisdiction labels, RTT sort.
- **T2.2 DAITA + post-quantum shields** — toggles + honest cost notes; `Shields` fields wired to core (maybe not DAITA, PQ PSK — doc 01).
- **T2.3 Direct-vs-relay path indicator** — `StatusChip` path field surfaced (P2P/ NAT-traversal vs DERP-style relay — doc 01).
- **T2.4 Console policy-as-code / GitOps** — `PolicyEditor` effect-diff + version history + one-click rollback.

Phase 3 — extended reach (the hard platforms) [04_P3, 04_UI §6.1]

- **T3.1 HarmonyOS NEXT** — OpenHarmony SIG fork build, ArkTS Network Kit ability, NAPI to the `.so`, DevEco signing. (Biggest platform risk.)
 - **T3.2 Aurora OS** — OMP fork build, Qt/C++ tunnel backend, Friflex bridge, RPM signing; enterprise SKU CI.
 - **T3.3 Web WASM MASQUE proxy** — optional in-page browser-scoped proxy in Console (not a system tunnel; CI3).
-

14. Open decisions surfaced by this document

Per §11.4.6/§11.4.66 — options + recommendation, never silently resolved. These are *client-stack* decisions (the program-level D1–D8 live in doc 00).

#	Decision	Option A	Option B	Recommendation
D-CLIENT-1	iOS NE memory fallback (if G3 fails)	shrink buffers / cap QUIC windows in iOS build	move MASQUE off-device for iOS (plain WG only) or split-core app-extension IPC	Gate on G3 measurement (§5.1). Prefer A (buffer caps) if it reaches $\geq 30\%$ headroom; B only if A insufficient. Each is a real product/feature decision — surface to operator [04_P0 §6.4].
D-CLIENT-2	App state management	Riverpod	Bloc	Riverpod — best fit for stream-driven UI + testability; the layering maps onto Bloc if the team prefers explicit event/state classes [04_UI §4].
D-CLIENT-3	Native shim binding generator	UniFFI (Swift/Kotlin) + frb (Dart)	cbindgen C header everywhere	UniFFI for native shims, frb for Dart — UniFFI gives typed Swift/Kotlin; cbindgen is the fallback where UniFFI support is thin (HarmonyOS/Aurora may need raw C) [04_ARCH §5.1, 04_P0 §6.1].
D-CLIENT-4	Connector UI	Flutter config UI (optional) + headless daemon	headless-only	Both — same Rust core; the Flutter UI is the <i>optional</i> surface, headless is primary on appliances [04_ARCH §5.4].
D-CLIENT-5	Web tunnel ambition	Console + optional WASM MASQUE in-page proxy	Console only	A (Phase 3) — be explicit it is browser-scoped, never a device VPN (CI3) [04_ARCH §5.7].

15. Cross-document contracts this document fixes

Contract	Fixed value	Consumed by
FFI surface (start/stop/status_stream/exits/setExit/setShields/advertise/attach_tun) + mirrored TunnelStatus/Shields/ExitOption	§3	doc 01 (must emit these events), all apps
TunnelPlatform channel contract (startTunnel/stopTunnel/events, TunnelConfig, PlatformTunnelEvent)	§4	every per-platform shim, doc 02 (device.revoked → revoked event)
Flavor + capability model (runHelixApp, Capability.*)	§6	the three apps; Console-no-core-ffi rule
Connection-state palette (Disconnected/Connecting/Connected/Danger → tokens)	§7.1	helix_design, every screen
UI-is-a-pure-function-of-the-status-stream rule (CI2)	§0.1/ §8	all reactive UI; the honesty guarantee
iOS NE memory ceiling = the Rust-core justification (G3)	§5.1/ §10	doc 01 build flags, the whole "Rust not Go" thesis

Sources verified

- 04_VPN_CLD/HelixVPN-helix-ui-Flutter.md [04_UI] — §0 (is/is-not), §1 (melos layout), §2 (flavors), §3 (design system + tokens + signature components), §4 (Riverpod), §5 (FFI surface), §6 (per-platform shim matrix + HarmonyOS/Aurora), §7 (responsive), §9 (ally/i18n), §10 (budgets), §11 (build/CI), §12 (testing).
- 04_VPN_CLD/HelixVPN-Architecture-Refined.md [04_ARCH] — §5.1–§5.7 (two-cores strategy, why Flutter, shim matrix, three apps, reuse map, size/memory/speed, honest platform caveats), §9 (observability), §11 (repo layout).
- 04_VPN_CLD/HelixVPN-Phase0-Spike.md [04_P0] — §4.5 (orchestrator + TunnelStatus broadcast), §6 (iOS NE memory experiment G3 + fallbacks), §9 (FFI boundary G5 + Rust/Dart skeletons), §10 (static map shape), §11 (graduation).
- [05_YB0] operator mandate — eight-platform requirement; tiny/fast/stable app bar. [SYN] cross-document synthesis — §4 (phases), §5 (client architecture), §6 (repo layout), §9 (constitution bindings).
- Sibling final docs 00-product-scope-and-principles.md (roles, D1–D8), 01-data-plane.md (Transport trait, helix-wg, orchestrator, status events), 02 (control plane: REST/WS, WatchNetworkMap, enrollment, device.revoked).

*Constitution: §11.4.44 (revision header), §11.4.6/§11.4.66 (decisions = options

- recommendation), §11.4.5/§11.4.69/§11.4.107/§11.4.158/§11.4.159 (captured/window-scoped evidence), §11.4.28/§11.4.74 (decoupled reusable packages),

§11.4.151/§11.4.155 (release/recording prefixes), §11.4.156 (no active CI),
§11.4.133 (signed privileged code / target safety).*

End of document 03 — Clients (helix-core FFI, Flutter helix-ui, per-platform shims).